MoveInSync Play Store ratings: what is holding them back and what to fix first

Oct 10, 2026 · @Drishtita

The app shows 4.64 stars from 114,835 ratings, but 7,336 of them (6.4%) are 1 star, and one in four written reviews over the last 18 months is 1 star. That share has not moved since April 2025, so this is a standing product problem, not one bad release. Fixing login and session loss, app stability and live tracking, and answering unhappy reviewers, is worth about +0.1 on the score.

Why ratings are stuck

About 55% of low-star reviews point at things the app can fix, about 18% at cab and driver operations, and 27% say only "worst app". I read 1,229 reviews rated 1 or 2 stars (7 Apr 2025 to 9 Oct 2026) and tagged each with one primary theme.

Theme (1-2 star reviews)	Reviews	Share	Who owns it	What people say
Crash, slow, errors	183	15%	App	Keeps loading, "something went wrong", will not open, freezes on booking
Login, OTP, logged out	179	15%	App	OTP never arrives, logged out every day, re-login while the cab is waiting
Tracking, GPS, ETA	83	7%	App	Cab pin frozen for 10 minutes, ETA off by hours, map zoom resets every 30 seconds
Booking, cancel, no-show	73	6%	App and ops	Auto-cancelled bookings, marked no-show after a schedule change, waitlist confusion
Forced feedback, popups, banners	64	5%	App	Cannot skip the rating after every trip, full-screen banner on each launch
Calling and helpdesk	42	3%	App and ops	"Calling disabled as per company policy", driver never picks up

Theme (1-2 star reviews)	Reviews	Share	Who owns it	What people say
QR, check-in, UI	54	4%	App	QR scan fails on some phones, too many steps to book a shuttle
Driver and service quality	125	10%	Ops	Rude or unprofessional drivers, staff, support
Pickup timing, routing	78	6%	Ops	Pickups scheduled too early, wrong route clubbing
Safety, SOS	18	1%	Ops and app	SOS does not work, unsafe for women
No detail or other	330	27%	Unknown	"Worst", "useless", "bekaar hai"

Three facts shape what to do:

- **It is chronic.** Monthly average of written reviews stayed between 3.52 and 4.04 for 19 months. The last 90 days (3.81 stars, 24.9% 1-star) match the 90 days before (3.84, 24.9%). No single release caused it.
- **One release made login worse.** Version 12.1.2, live from 17 Jun 2025, has 258 reviews, 33% of them 1-2 stars. Logout complaints jumped to 16 that month and keep coming back (12 in Oct 2025). Version 12.19.0 is the worst recent one at 34% (99 reviews).
- **Almost nobody hears back.** Only 122 of 4,400 reviews have a developer reply (2.8%). Just 51 of 1,085 one-star reviews got one (4.7%), while 49% of all replies went to 4-5 star reviewers with a "Great to hear!" message.

What to fix first

Start with login and the forced-feedback popups, because both are cheap and visible in reviews, then stability and tracking. The three biggest app themes (login, stability, tracking) together are 36% of low-star reviews, worth about +0.07 to +0.10 on the all-time score; every app-owned theme together is worth +0.11 to +0.15.

Order	Fix	Owner	Effort	Success metric (90 days)	Lift on all-time score
1	Keep people logged in: long-lived session, OTP only on a new device, resend button, a clear "number not registered" message	Engineering (auth)	Medium	Login and logout share of 1-2 star reviews from 15% to under 5%	+0.03

Order	Fix	Owner	Effort	Success metric (90 days)	Lift on all-time score
2	Remove the mandatory rating after every trip and the full-screen banner on launch; make rating optional and ask once a week	Product	Low	Forced-feedback and popup complaints from 5% to under 1%	+0.01
3	Reply to every 1-2 star review within 48 hours using themed templates; send safety and billing cases to support	Support	Low	Reply rate on 1-2 star reviews from 4.7% to over 80%	Not estimated
4	Stability and speed: crash-free sessions, cold-start time, cached trip details for weak networks	Engineering (mobile)	High	Crash and slow complaints from 15% to under 8%	+0.03
5	Tracking you can trust: "updated 2 min ago" stamp, fix the frozen pin, stop map auto-zoom resetting, push alert when the ETA slips by 10 minutes	Engineering and ops	Medium	Tracking complaints from 7% to under 3%	+0.01
6	Booking and calling: show why a trip was cancelled or marked no-show, notify on admin schedule changes, show the helpdesk number when calling is blocked by company policy	Product and ops	Medium	Booking and calling complaints from 9% to under 5%	+0.02
7	Release gate: staged rollout of 10%, 50%, 100%, and pause if a new version's first 100 reviews are over 30% low-star	Release engineering	Low	No version above 30% low-star (12.1.2 and 12.19.0 hit 33-34%)	Protects the rest
8	Ops hand-off: send the transport desk a monthly list of reviews naming drivers, routes and pickup times	Operations	Low	Driver and pickup complaints from 16% to under 10%	Not estimated

How I estimated lift: written 1-2 star reviews are assumed to be a fair sample of all 8,164 one- and two-star ratings, and each fixed review moves from about 1 star to 4 stars (to 5 stars gives about a third more).

One trap: the all-time score is a plain average (the histogram gives 4.638, the same as shown), so it moves slowly. Going from 4.64 to 4.74 would take about 45,000 new 5-star ratings. Track the rolling 90-day average of written reviews and the 1-star share instead; the target is 1-star share from 25% to 18% in 90 days.

First 2 weeks

By day 14, the cheap fixes ship and the harder ones are scoped with a baseline.

1. **Days 1-2:** Support starts replying to the 1,085 one-star reviews, newest first, using three templates (login, crash, tracking). Product agrees to drop the forced post-trip rating.
2. **Days 1-3:** Engineering pulls Play Console vitals (crash-free sessions, ANR rate, start-up time) and the auth logs for 12.1.2, to set baselines for tickets 1 and 4.
3. **Days 3-7:** Ship the optional rating and the banner removal (ticket 2). Turn on the staged rollout and the 30% low-star alert (fix 7).
4. **Days 5-10:** Build the persistent session and the OTP fixes (ticket 1) and put them in a staged release.
5. **Days 8-14:** Scope the tracking changes (ticket 3) with the ops team, and send the transport desk the first monthly list of driver and pickup complaints.
6. **Day 14:** Run the rating notebook again and compare against today: 90-day average 3.81, 1-star share 24.9%, reply rate on 1-2 stars 4.7%.

Three tickets ready to start

Ticket 1: Stop logging people out and fix OTP delivery (Engineering, auth)

- Problem: 179 low-star reviews (15%) are about OTP not arriving or being logged out, often while the cab is waiting. Version 12.1.2 triggered a wave from 17 Jun 2025.
- Do: keep a refresh token so a session lasts at least 30 days; ask for OTP only on a new device or after the user signs out; add a resend timer and a message that says whether the number or email is registered.
- Accept when: a user stays logged in across 30 days of app opens in test; login on a weak network shows a retry, not a blank screen; OTP delivery success and median delivery time are logged per carrier.
- Measure: logout and OTP mentions among 1-2 star reviews under 5%.

Ticket 2: Make trip rating optional and remove launch banners (Product)

- Problem: 64 low-star reviews (5%) say the rating cannot be skipped after every trip, or that a full-screen banner blocks the cab details on each launch (seen in 12.2.1 and 12.11.2).
- Do: add a skip button on the rating screen, ask at most once a week, and show promotions only on the home tab below the trip card.
- Accept when: a user can open the app, see cab number and OTP, and board without touching a popup; rating prompts appear at most once in 7 days per user.
- Measure: forced-feedback and popup mentions under 1% of low-star reviews.

Ticket 3: Show how fresh the cab location is and warn on delays (Engineering and ops)

- Problem: 83 low-star reviews (7%) report a frozen cab pin, ETA that is hours off, or a map that resets its zoom every 30 seconds while the user waits.
- Do: show "updated X min ago" on the live pin; if the last update is over 3 minutes old, say so instead of showing a stale position; stop the automatic zoom reset after the user pans; send a push when the ETA slips by 10 minutes or more.
- Accept when: the pin age is visible on every tracking screen; the map keeps the user's zoom for the whole wait; the delay push arrives within 60 seconds of the ETA change in staging.
- Measure: tracking and ETA mentions under 3% of low-star reviews.

How I got here and what to trust

The themes are good enough to rank fixes, but the percentages are approximate: on a hand check of 45 random low-star reviews, about 75% had the right primary theme.

- **Data:** the employee app (com.moveinsync.ets) on Google Play, India store. The listing shows 4.64 stars, 114,835 ratings, 1M+ installs; the rating histogram averages to 4.638, so the plain average matches. I scraped the 4,400 written reviews from 7 Apr 2025 to 9 Oct 2026, with stars, date, app version, upvotes and developer reply. An early search result showed 4.32, which I dropped in favour of the app page and histogram.
- **Tools:** Python with google-play-scraper and pandas in Google Colab for collection and analysis; Claude for classification rules, spot checks, and drafting this memo.
- **Method:** each 1-2 star review gets one primary theme from ordered keyword rules built around the commute journey (login, booking, pickup, tracking, boarding, support). Themes are marked app or ops. Lift assumes the written low-star reviews are a fair sample of all low-star ratings.
- **Limits:** written reviews skew negative (1 star is 25% of them against 6.4% of all ratings), so they explain why people complain, not the score itself. "Crash, slow, errors" uses broad keywords and is probably overstated. 27% of low-star reviews have no

usable detail. I did not check Hindi-script reviews separately. I did not talk to customers, and late cabs and drivers need the transport desks' view before ops targets are set.

- **Repeatable:** the attached notebook answers "How are our Play Store ratings?" in one run: displayed score, 90-day trend, reasons for low stars, worst versions, reply rate, and the unanswered low-star reviews to answer first. Next step would be a weekly scheduled run and model-based tagging to lift accuracy.